



GDD 41

Heart Smart

Smart with feelings, kind to all

The emotional-intelligence game for ages 6-9, built to the mechanic-embodiment standard. Children name the trickier feelings, build a bigger calm-down toolkit, see others' side, sort out conflict, and grow kindness and gratitude. Seven mechanics, thirty-five real-choice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Smart with feelings, kind to all.

Heart Smart is the Chapter 2 emotional-intelligence game, the deeper, 6-9 sequel to Feelings Friends (g01): naming the trickier feelings (jealousy, worry, disappointment, gratitude), building a real toolkit for big feelings, seeing others' side (empathy and perspective-taking), getting along and repairing conflict, and growing kindness and gratitude. It completes Chapter 2 to the v2 standard. New v2 build to the persona-and-research standard.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g41 · heart-smart (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 2 · ages 6-9 · light canvas · solo or co-play
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills · UNESCO 5.6, 5.3, 5.2, 1.3
Prerequisite / builds on	g09 (Friend or Frenemy) · builds on g01 (Feelings Friends)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS new build, completes Chapter 2.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

35

real-choice moves

10

myths busted

0%

binary taps

Bigger kids, bigger feelings.

From the Chapter 2 personas. At 6-9 the feelings get more complex and social, this game gives every child the deeper toolkit.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Reyansh, 7 (loses it when he loses)	To handle frustration without blowing up.	branch + role-play: name it, breathe, try again.
Ananya, 8 (worrier, justice)	To handle worry and disagree respectfully.	branch + reflect: calm worry; calm conflict.
"Faizan"-type	That feelings & empathy are for boys too.	strike-rewrite: "empathy is for everyone".
Sana, 14 (older sibling)	To comfort and not dismiss a younger kid.	branch: "it's big to them".
Aditi (parent, joint family)	Calm tools for sibling/cousin squabbles.	branch + build: fair turns; repair steps.

Why this works (the evidence). By 6-9, children recognise complex emotions (jealousy, worry, gratitude) and can build a real toolkit, self-talk, perspective-taking, breathing, problem-solving when calm, and empathy deepens from affective to cognitive (understanding others' viewpoints), which underpins better friendships. So this game extends naming-feelings into managing them and reading others.

Seven moves, one heart.

The rework's heart: emotional intelligence arrives through seven actions, led by deciding real feeling-moments and reflecting honestly. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
reflect	Checks in on feelings, their own and others' (no wrong answer).	Self-awareness; metacognition.	23
branch (dilemma)	Chooses how to handle a feeling or conflict, sees the result.	Regulation; getting along.	23
role-play (voice)	Says the self-talk / 'I' line / caring words.	Self-talk; assertion; empathy.	12
strike-rewrite	Erases a feelings myth ("squash it down").	Conceptual change.	10
match	Pairs feeling to coping move, situation to how others feel.	Coping; perspective.	7
sort	Feeling vs action; calms vs fuels; kind vs unkind.	Telling them apart.	5
build	Builds a heart toolkit / repair steps / kindness plan.	Strategies, made concrete.	4

35 of 84 moments are branch or role-play, the most of any game, because emotional skill is learned by doing. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

It plays like coaching your own heart through real moments: losing a game, a flash of jealousy, a fight with a friend, a worried night. You make the call, feel the difference a good move makes, build your own toolkit, and earn the quiet win of handling a big feeling well, which feels genuinely satisfying at this age.

Is it teaching?

Yes, the deeper SEL curriculum for 6-9: naming complex emotions, a bigger regulation toolkit (breathe, self-talk, move, talk, problem-solve when calm), empathy and perspective-taking, conflict repair, and kindness and gratitude, all decided and rehearsed, building directly on Feelings Friends.

The belief it moves. From "jealousy makes me bad; squash feelings down; getting along means never disagreeing; empathy is just for girls; once a feeling's big I'm stuck" → "all feelings are okay, I have tools for the big ones, I can see others' side and repair a fight, and kindness lifts everyone."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across six categories, India-grounded (exam worry, sibling/cousin jealousy, joint-family squabbles) and CASEL-aligned. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Naming the trickier feelings	14	match, reflect, strike-rewrite	Jealousy, worry, disappointment, embarrassment, pride, gratitude; mixed feelings.
Handling big feelings	14	branch, match, role-play	Breathe, self-talk, walk away, move, the wave that passes; plan B.
Empathy & others' side	14	branch, match, role-play	Notice & ask; perspective-take; share joy; everyone's feelings are real.
Getting along & conflict	12	branch, role-play, build	Calm-then-solve; 'I' statements; repair steps; own your part.
Kindness & gratitude	14	branch, reflect, build	Small kind acts; gratitude; kindness lifts the giver too.
My heart toolkit	16	build, branch, role-play	Name-breathe-talk-move-solve; ask for help; kind self-talk; flexibility.

A branch scenario (regulation), verbatim.

hook: "You lose a game and feel like throwing the board."
 option A "Breathe, say 'I'm frustrated', then try again" -> the feeling shrinks [best]
 option B "Throw the board and storm off" -> it stays big; friends upset
 debrief: "Name it and breathe first; then the feeling is small enough to handle."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 41 Heart Smart — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game erases.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Feeling jealous makes you a bad person.	Jealousy is normal; it's what you do with it that counts.	Emotion validation.
If I feel worried, something must be really wrong.	Worry is your mind preparing, not proof of danger.	Anxiety / cognitive.
You should squash big feelings down.	Let them out safely; squashing makes them bigger.	Emotion regulation.
Others feel exactly what I feel.	Others can feel differently; imagine their side.	Perspective-taking.
People who get along never disagree.	Everyone disagrees; it's about how you handle it.	Conflict / repair.
Caring about feelings is only for girls.	Empathy and emotional skills are for everyone.	Gender / SEL.
Being kind is a waste of time.	Kindness helps others AND lifts you too.	Prosocial / wellbeing.
Strong people don't need help with feelings.	Asking for help with feelings is a sign of strength.	Help-seeking.
Once a feeling's big, you're stuck with it.	You always have a tool: name, breathe, move, talk, ask.	Agency / regulation.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy drops you into a real feeling-moment: "ooh, big feeling, what now?".
2. **Play.** One of seven mechanics, led by decide/reflect, rotated.
3. **See the difference.** A branch choice shows how a good move shrinks the feeling or mends the moment.
4. **UN → RE moment.** On a myth, UN erases it and RE writes the truth ("squash it" → "let it out safely").
5. **Apply.** Say the self-talk, build your toolkit, or do a kindness.
6. **Sticker.** The Heart Smart badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surfaces: the **feeling-moment dilemmas**, the **heart-toolkit** builder, and **say-the-self-talk** rehearsal. Builds directly on Feelings Friends (g01); pairs with Friend or Frenemy (g09).

Warm, real, validating.

- **Register.** Ages 6-9, never babyish; warm and real, treats bigger feelings with respect.
- **All feelings valid.** Never shames a feeling (jealousy, worry included); separates feeling from action.
- **Both directions.** Empathy and emotional skill are explicitly for boys too (links the gender thread).
- **Safe to be wrong.** Branch choices debrief gently; reflects have no wrong answer.
- **Help-seeking normalised.** "Ask a trusted grown-up" is a toolkit move, not a last resort; very big feelings route to support.
- **Access.** Audio-first, calm-mode, offline; India contexts (exam worry, joint-family squabbles); co-play.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. heart-smart** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** Each scenario carries type + typed payload (branch.options, reflect.options, role-play.yourLine, strike-rewrite.myth, match.pairs, sort.items/bins/key, build.pieces/sequence). Reuses the shared templates from g09.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, max 27%, 0% binary, 35 autonomy, 10 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Cross-links.** Builds on g01 (feelings vocabulary, calmers); pairs with g09 (friendship) and feeds Ch.3 Mind Matters (g38) & Bounce (g39).
- **Generated path.** Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): all feelings valid; feeling vs action; empathy for everyone; safe-to-be-wrong; normalise help-seeking; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Complex feelings, real tools.** By 6-9, children recognise complex emotions (jealousy, worry, disappointment, gratitude) and can use a toolkit, self-talk, perspective-taking, breathing, walking away, and problem-solving once calm, which this game builds and rehearses.
- **Empathy deepens.** Empathy shifts from mainly affective to also cognitive (understanding others' viewpoints) in middle childhood, and perspective-taking supports better peer relationships, so the game makes "see their side" a core, practised move.
- **Name, then act, then solve.** Effective emotion coaching is: name the feeling, choose a coping action, and problem-solve when calm, and children copy the strategies they see modelled, which is why the game models and rehearses each step.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 14 games now v2, and this completes Chapter 2 to the v2 standard. Next: Chapter 3 (ages 9-12), beginning with Puberty Quest (g13).